

**Mansoura University
Faculty of Computers
and Information
Department of
Information System
First Semester- 2024-
2025**

Agile Methods

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Lecture 8

Requirement Modeling In Practical (Fact-finding)

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2024



Agile Analysis

Agile Requirement analysis techniques

Personas as agile technique

➤ **Four Different perspectives of personas**

- Goal-Directed Personas
- Role-Based Personas
- Engaging Personas
- Fictional Personas

➤ **Eight tips for creating agile personas**

User Stories



Ask yourself



Who is my user and what does that tell me?





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Modeling.htm

Agile Modeling

Agile Modeling (AM) is a **practice-based** methodology for effective modeling and documentation of software-based systems.

At a high level AM is a collection of Core Practices, depicted in the **pattern language map**.

At a more **detailed** level AM is a collection of **values, principles, and practices** for modeling software that can be applied on a software development project in an **effective and light-weight** manner.



Personas as Agile Technique

“We believe that technology is at its very best; at its most empowering when it disappears”

— Jonathan Ive

“Mary”



Behaviors

- Has a housecleaner
- Buys take-away 3 nights/wk
- Frequently feels overwhelmed when she “forgets” something

Demographics

- Working mom
- 34 years old
- Lives in Reading, works in London
- Married, 2 kids
- Household 125k/yr

Needs & Goals

- Help! Running errands, managing kids, keeping things running
- Time for her girlfriends
- To feel like she “has it sorted”
- “To clone herself”

PERSONAS AS AGILE TECHNIQUE

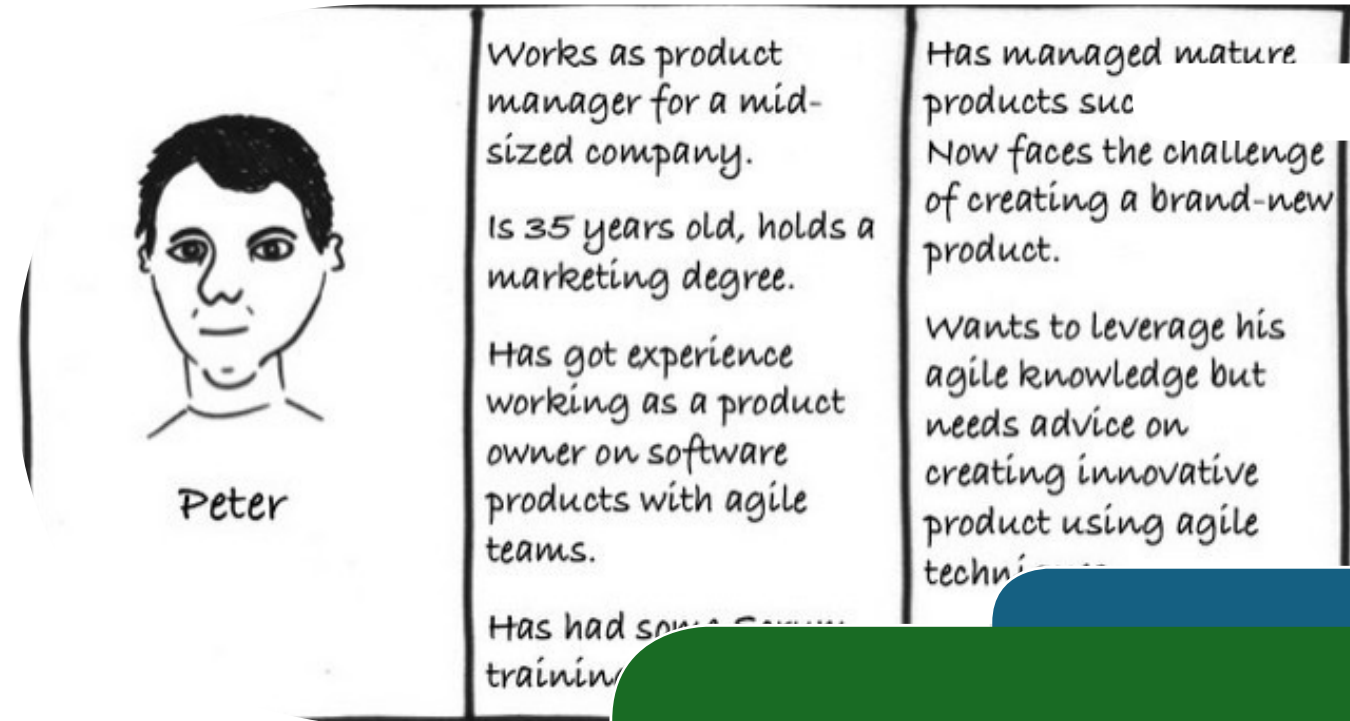
Personas are **fictional characters**, which you create based upon your research in order to represent the different user types that might use your service, product, site, or brand in a similar way.

Personas are a powerful technique to describe the users and customers of a product in order to make the right product decisions.

Personas provide **meaningful archetypes** which you can use to assess your design development against.

Why Personas?

- Constructing personas will help you ask the right questions and answer those questions in line with the users you are designing for.
- Example:
- “How would Peter, Joe, and Jessica experience, react, and behave in relation to feature X or change Y within the given context?”
- “What do Peter, Joe, and Jessica think, feel, do and say?” and “What are their underlying needs we are trying to fulfill?”





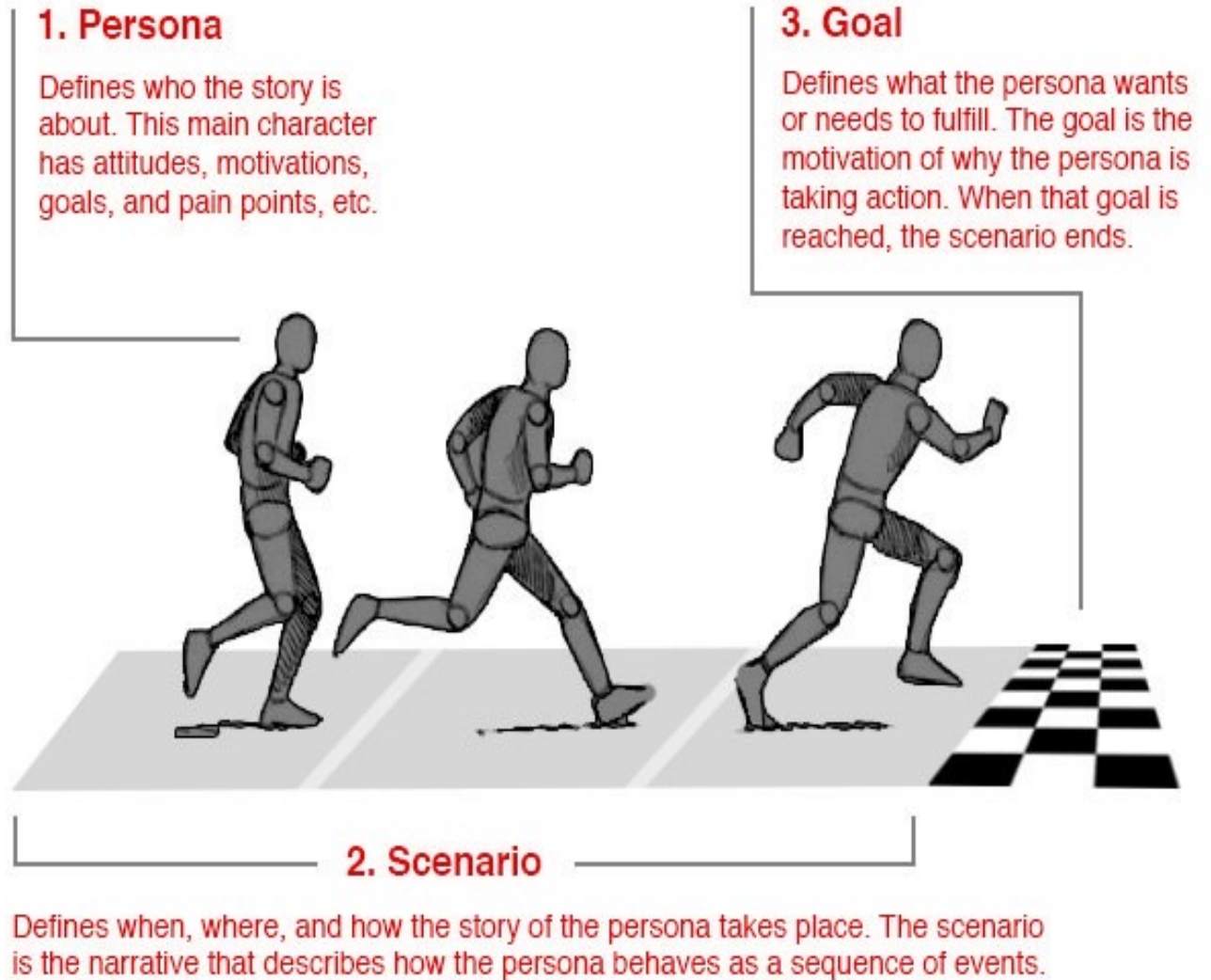
LENE NIELSEN
Associate Professor | IT University of Copenhagen

FOUR DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVES ON PERSONAS

Lene Nielsen, describes four perspectives that your personas can take to ensure that they add the most value to your design project and the fiction-based perspective.

Goal-Directed Persona

- This persona cuts straight to the **nitty-gritty**. “It focusses on: What does my typical user want to do with my product?”.
- The objective of a goal-directed persona is to examine the process and workflow that user would prefer to utilize in order to achieve their objectives.



ROLE-BASED PERSONA

- The role-based perspective is also goal-directed and it also focusses on **behavior**.
- The personas of the role-based perspectives are massively **data-driven** and incorporate data from both qualitative and quantitative sources.
- The role-based perspective focusses on the user's role in the organization.



"I want to own the latest technology – NOW!"

Persona Name

Tomas the Techie

Role

Senior IT Project Manager

Age

31

Job Description

Tomas manages several multi-million dollar projects for a global IT company, responsible for developing and implementing solutions to drive process improvements and cost savings.

Decision Making Hierarchy

Queen

Location

Cologne, Germany

Marital Status

Single, no children

Salary

\$159K

Employment History

Tomas has been with this company since getting his MBA, working his way up from Computer Programmer to Senior Project Manager, the position he has held for a year.



Values

- Innovation; continuously on the lookout for innovative products/services
- Brands; highly involved and very knowledgeable
- A "good deal"
- Logic, rational thought
- His mobile phone – feels lost without it

Motivators

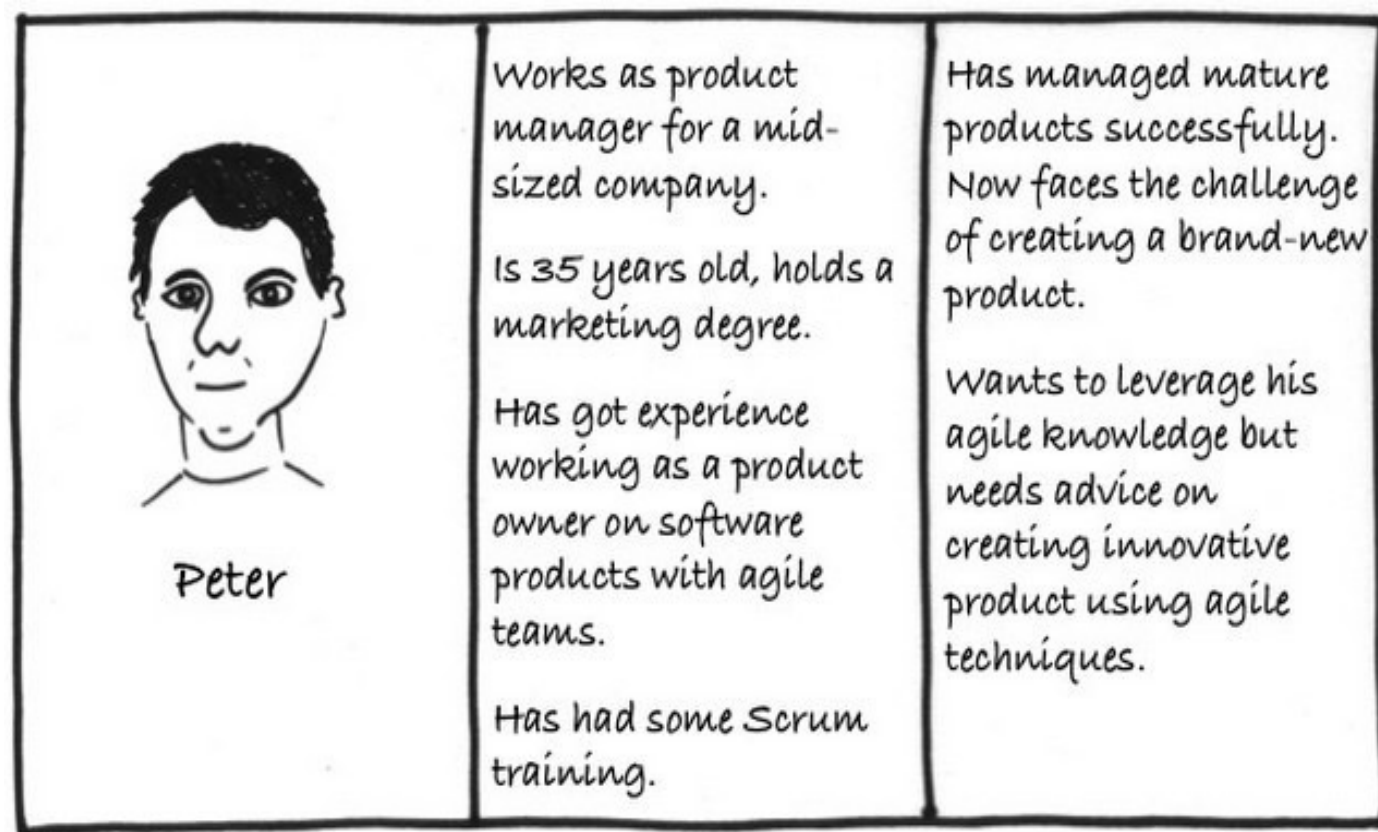
- Innovation
- Proficiency
- Complexity
- Risk
- Excellence

Referents & Influences



ENGAGING PERSONAS

- The **engaging perspective** is rooted in the ability of stories to produce involvement and insight.
- Through an understanding of characters and stories, it is possible to create a vivid and realistic description of fictitious people.
- Engaging personas can incorporate both **goal and role-directed** personas, as well as the more traditional rounded personas.



FICTIONAL PERSONAS

- The fictional persona does not emerge from user research (unlike the other personas) but it emerges from the experience of the UX (User Experience) design team.
- It requires the team to make assumptions based upon past interactions with the user base, and products to deliver a picture of what, perhaps, typical users look like.





BIG IMAGE

“Personas are the single most powerful design tool that we use. They are the foundation for all subsequent goal-directed design. Personas allow us to see the scope and nature of the design problem... [They] are the bright light under which we do surgery.”

— Alan Cooper, Software designer, programmer and the “Father of Visual Basic”

8 TIPS FOR CREATING AGILE PERSONAS

Roman Pichler created good 10 tips to create agile personas, just listing 8 of them.



ROMAN PICHLER

Leading agile product management and Scrum expert.

1- GET TO KNOW THE USERS

- Any persona description should be based on knowledge gained from direct interaction with the target customers and users.
- This is necessary to build a connection with the beneficiaries of product, develop empathy, and understand their current wants, needs, and circumstances.



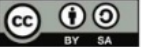
2- KEEP YOUR PERSONAS CONCISE

- Roman recommend that make and keep the personas concise so they fit on an A4 sheet of paper.
- Be careful not to bloat them and don't add irrelevant details, for instance, another spare time activity or a cute pet.
- Too much detail makes them difficult to work with. Only include information that helps the analyst make informed decisions.

ROMAN'S PERSONA TEMPLATE		
 PICTURE & NAME	 DETAILS	 GOAL
What does the persona look like? What is its name? Choose a realistic and believable picture and name.	What are the persona's relevant characteristics and behaviours? For instance, demographics, such as age, gender, occupation, and income; psychographics, including lifestyle, social class, and personality; and behavioural attributes like usage patterns, attitudes, and brand loyalty. Only list relevant details.	What problem does the persona want to solve or which benefit does the character seek? Why would the persona want to use or buy the product?

www.romanpichler.com
Template version 04/17

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3- DISTINGUISH USER AND BUYER PERSONAS

- Create separate user and customer personas whenever the users and the customers are not the same people.
- This allows analyst to capture the user and the customer-specific needs, and it makes divergent or conflicting goals easier to see.

User Persona	Buyer Persona
	
Christina - CRM Specialist Artisan	Kevin - IT Specialist Guardian
Goals The main goal is for the product to be easy in use and not a road block when trying to solve a particular problem.	Goals To get a product that is easy to integrate into the current IT infrastructure, that doesn't require intensive support.
Motivations - Intuitive interface - Easy to learn and use	Motivations - Easy integration with current infrastructure - Secure
Frustrations - Messy navigation - Not clear what to do at each stage.	Frustrations - Requires a lot of support

4- CHOOSE A PRIMARY PERSONA

- Whenever create several personas for a product, choose one primary persona.
- The primary persona is the character mainly design and build the product for.



5- MAKE PERSONAS BELIEVABLE

- Personas should help the development team empathize with the users and view the product from their perspective.
- To achieve this, personas must be believable. The following three tips help with this:
 - Base personas on first-hand user research (as discussed above).
 - Choose a representative name and picture.
 - Formulate personas together with the development team.



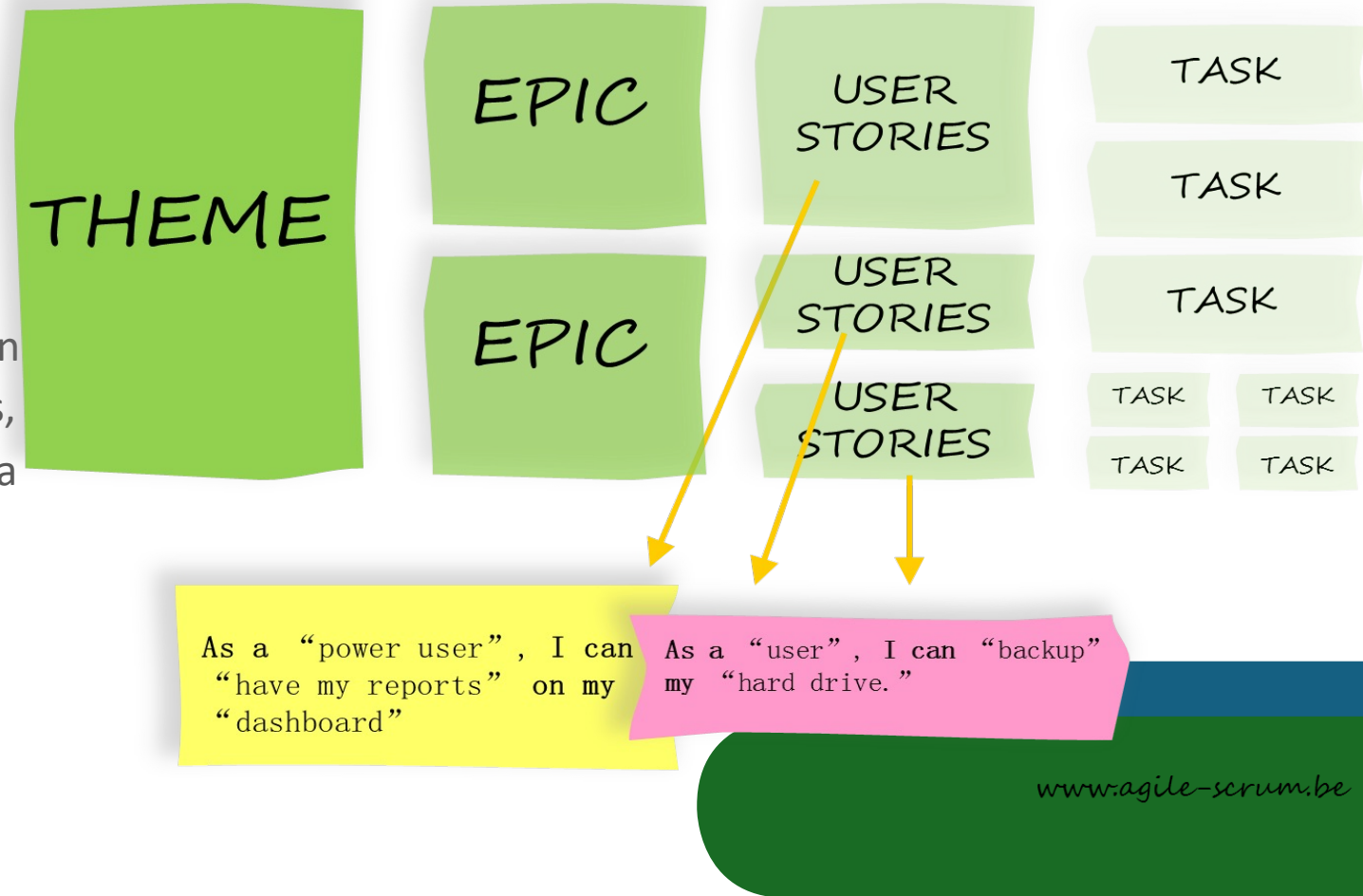
6- FOCUS ON THE MAIN BENEFIT OR PROBLEM

- Frequently see personas that contain a lengthy list of goals.
- While it is perfectly OK that a persona description provides more than one problem or benefit.
- Roman recommend selecting one main problem or benefit—the true reason why the persona would want to use or purchase the product.
- Pain Point ??????????????



7- CONNECT PERSONAS AND USER STORIES

- Make the most of personas, and use them in the scenarios, the storyboards, the workflows, and the user stories discover: primary persona should be the protagonist in stories.
- Template:
- As a <Persona>
- I want <What?>
- So That <Why?>

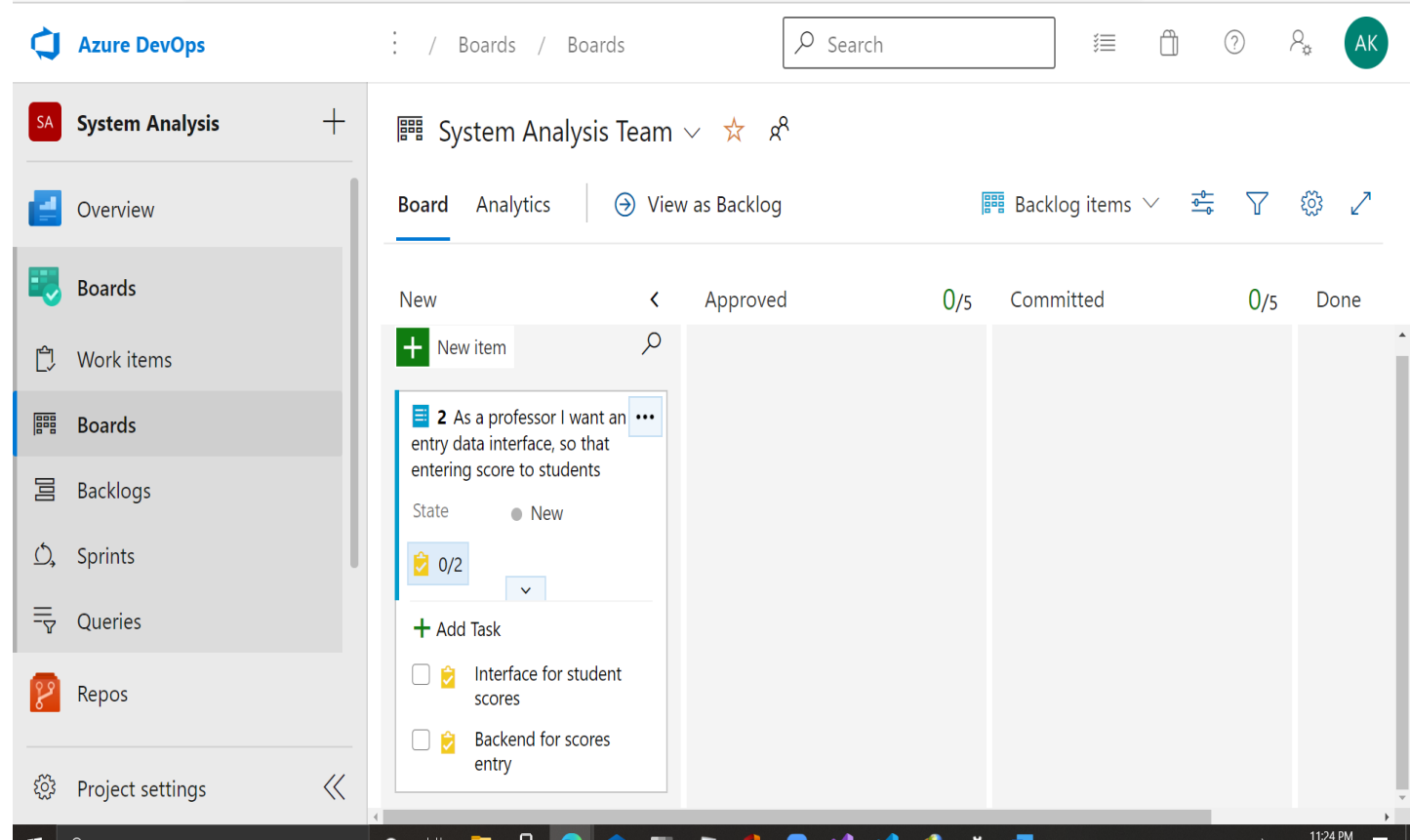


- Make personas visible and accessible to everyone involved in the development effort.
- Find working with paper-based personas very beneficial, and, Like to put them on the Product Canvas.



8- VISUALIZE PERSONAS

- A good tool for managing the requirements and user stories is Azure DevOps boards.





THANK YOU!

